ANA ARMENDARIZ

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PhD candidate in Economics and Econometrics at the University of St Gallen (HSG). My research is in applied microeconomics and econometrics. I study the effects of public policies on health and crime, and develop methods for causal inference, treatment effect heterogeneity and policy evaluation.

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics and Econometrics — August 2023 – Expected July 2027
University of St Gallen — *St Gallen, Switzerland*
Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Michael Lechner.

Master in Data Analytics and Economics — September 2021 – May 2023
University of Fribourg — *Fribourg, Switzerland*
GPA 5.35/6, *magna cum laude*.

Bachelor in Economics — September 2017 – July 2021
Universidad de las Américas — *Quito, Ecuador*
GPA 3.7/4.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Researcher and Research Assistant — August 2023 – Present
Swiss Institute for Empirical Economic Research (SEW), University of St Gallen — *St Gallen, Switzerland*

Visiting PhD Researcher — February 2026 – July 2026
Universidad Autónoma de Madrid, Departamento de Análisis Económico — *Madrid, Spain*
Hosts: Eugenio Zucchelli, Jorge García Hombrados and Ana Nuevo Chiquero.

Research Assistant — July 2022 – October 2022
Chair of Applied Econometrics and Policy Evaluation, University of Fribourg — *Fribourg, Switzerland*
Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Martin Huber.

RESEARCH

Working papers

Do Drug Consumption Rooms Reduce Drug-Related Hospitalizations? Evidence from Switzerland
Job Market Paper

Testing Effect Homogeneity and Confounding in High-Dimensional Experimental and Observational Studies
with Martin Huber. arXiv:2602.19703

Work in progress

When Do Common Trends and Unconfoundedness Agree? An Overidentification Test — with Martin Huber
Precisely Zero: Migration's Null Effect on Crime — *with Riccardo Ciacci*
Overfitting in Policy Learning — *with Michael Lechner, and Jana Mareckova*

TEACHING

University of St Gallen

Data Handling: Bachelor level course. Course tutor — Autumn 2026
Microeconomics: Bachelor level course. Exercise sessions — Autumn 2026
Introduction to R: Bachelor level workshop. Instructor — Autumn 2026
Microeconometrics: Master level course. Course assistant — Spring 2025
Macroeconomics: Bachelor level course. Exercise sessions — Spring 2025
Causal Machine Learning: PhD level course. Course assistant — Autumn 2024, Spring 2025

University of Fribourg

Applied Econometrics: Bachelor level course. Course assistant — Autumn 2022

Universidad de las Américas

International Economics and Principles of Economics: Bachelor level courses. Course assistant — 2019 – 2020

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

2026: EuHEA Conference (Rotterdam); IAAE Annual Conference (Portugal, session chair); 3rd Workshop on the Economics of Health and Human Capital (Madrid); CSS Health Economics Workshop (Lucerne); Congress of the Asociación de Economía del Ecuador (Quito); Research Seminar, Universidad Autónoma de Madrid; HERB

Workshop, University of Bologna; SEW Research Seminar and Brown Bag Seminar, University of St Gallen (forthcoming)

2025: Internal PhD Seminar and Stammtisch Seminar, University of St Gallen

AWARDS AND GRANTS

DocMobility Grant (CHF 22,600), University of St Gallen — October 2025
PhD Project Fund (CHF 770), Swiss Society of Health Economics — June 2025
Aschinger Prize for Latin American Academic Achievement, University of Fribourg — September 2023
José Corsino Cárdenas Research Prize (second place), Central Bank of Ecuador — April 2021
Honor Roll, Universidad de las Américas — Spring 2020, Autumn 2021
Summer School Scholarship, Yale University — August 2019

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Reviewer: *Empirical Economics*

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

The New and Wondrous Econometrics of Causal Inference, Study Center Gerzensee — February 2025
Machine Learning for Treatment Effects and Structural Equation Models, Study Center Gerzensee — August 2024
HSG Mentoring Programme, University of St Gallen — 2024 – 2026
Winter School in Data Analytics and Machine Learning, University of Fribourg — February 2022
Summer School, Yale University — July 2019

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Workshop Instructor — April 2026 – Present
Fundación Avanzar — *Cuenca, Ecuador*

Innovation Lab Officer — June 2022 – June 2023
Fribourg School of Management — *Fribourg, Switzerland*

Junior Analyst — August 2019 – June 2020
Vamos Pasajes S.A. — *Quito, Ecuador*

SKILLS

Programming Python, R (advanced), LaTeX (advanced), SQL (intermediate), Stata (intermediate), Git (intermediate)

Languages Spanish (native), English (C1), French (B2), Russian (B1), German (A2)